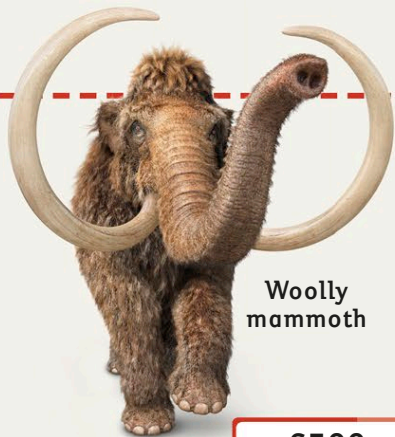




Woolly mammoth

14,000–9,000 years ago

The climate warms

The world gets warmer; sea levels rise; and forests spread. Many big animals, such as mammoths, die out.



Jomon pot

13,000 BCE

Pottery invented

The Jomon people of Japan make the world's oldest known pottery.

6500 BCE

Earliest silk making

Silk begins to be spun in China. Silk is a fine fabric made from the cocoons of the silk moth.



Silk worms

7000 BCE

First cloth woven

People in the Fertile Crescent learn to weave cloth from the fibers of a plant called flax.

10,000 BCE

Farming begins

In the Fertile Crescent, stretching from Egypt to Iraq, people begin to plant wheat and barley and raise animals for meat and milk.



3300 BCE

Writing invented

Egyptians invent the world's first writing system, hieroglyphs.



Egyptian hieroglyphs

3100 BCE

Egypt united

Egypt becomes a single kingdom under the rule of a pharaoh, perhaps called Narmer.



3000 BCE

Bronze Age begins

Mesopotamians mix tin and copper to make bronze, a harder metal. Soon after, bronze is also made in China.

3000 BCE

South American farming begins

Farming starts in the Andes mountains of South America, where people grow crops including potatoes.



South American potatoes

c.1200 BCE

Iron Age begins

The Bronze Age ends, and the Iron Age begins when people in Anatolia (modern Turkey) start making iron.



King Sargon

c.1200 BCE

First American civilizations

The Olmecs of Mesoamerica and the people of Chavin de Huantar in Peru live in the first American civilizations.

c.1000–500 BCE

Farming spreads in Africa

Farming people move from Nigeria to settle across much of Africa. They grow yams, millet, and sorghum. In 400 BCE, they begin making iron tools.

334–323 BCE

Alexander the Great

After uniting Greece, Alexander the Great of Macedonia conquers an empire stretching from Egypt to India.

c.500–336 BCE

Ancient Greece

Greek civilization is at its peak. The Greeks create beautiful art and architecture and invent science, philosophy, theater, history writing, and politics.

